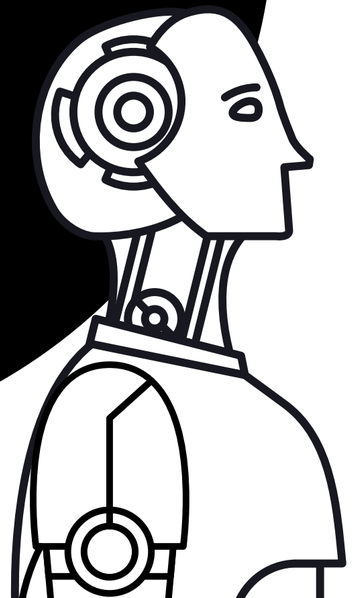
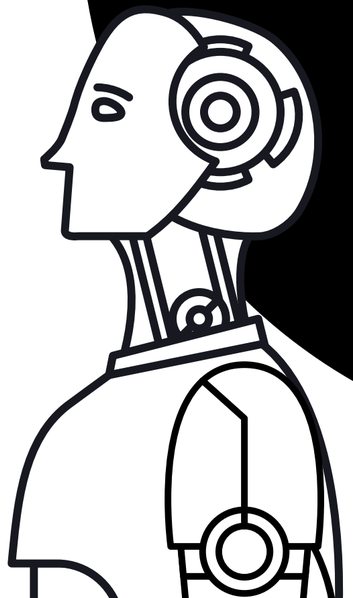
TECHNOLOGY WORKFLOW

GITHUB COPILOT (VS CODE)
&
GOOGLE CALENDAR





Colby Reynolds • Tech Skills • Feb 24

TOOL SELECTION & RATIONAL

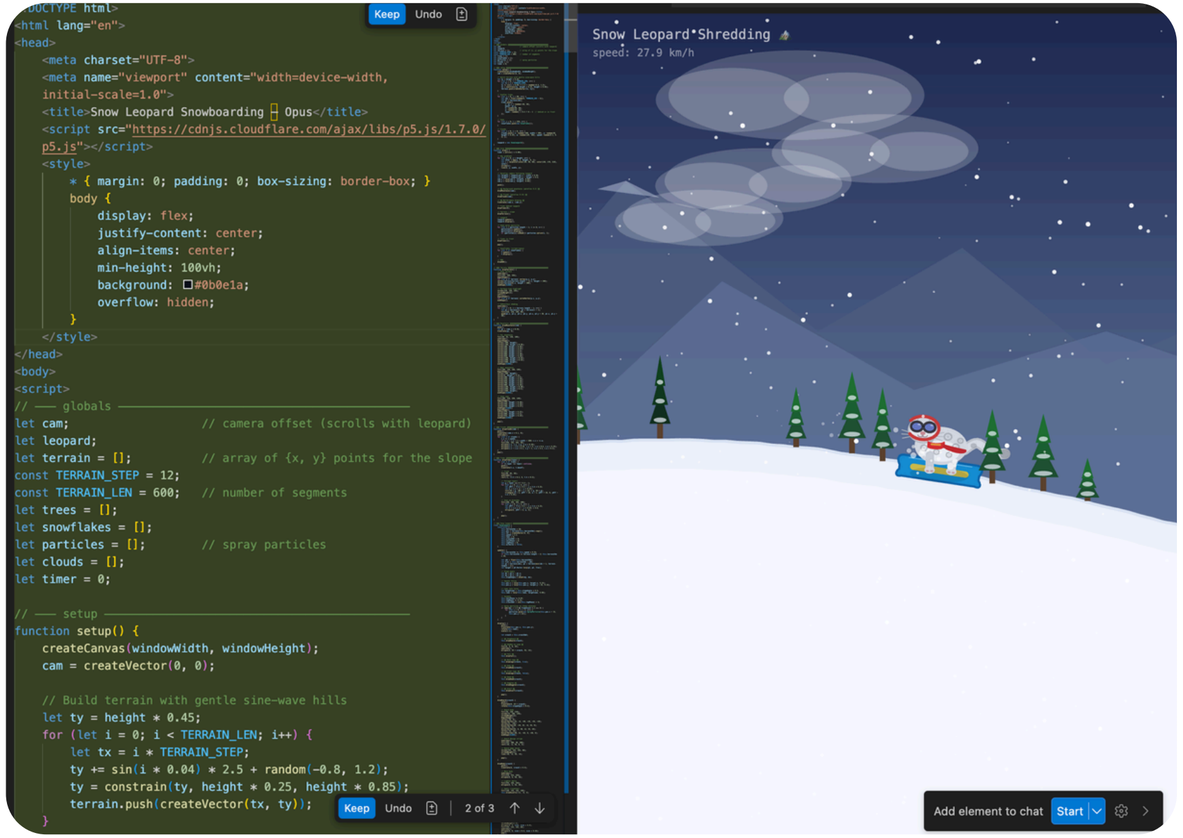
GITHUB COPILOT

- I have mulitple classes that require coding, and I wanted a faster way to prototype and build web projects
- Copilot lets me “vibe code” by generating starter code, debugging, and iterating quickly inside VS code (an app used to write code).

GOOGLE CALENDAR

- I needed a consistent way to set aside time for my classwork and classes and avoid cramming.
- Time-blocking and scheduling helped me follow through on building and refining my project

TOOL 1 OVERVIEW: GITHUB COPILOT



Screenshot of the code that Copilot wrote, along with preview of the snowleopard game

01

WHAT IT DOES

- AI chat integrated into VS Code that helps generate code, explain code, debug issues, and refactor
- Supports quick iteration: prompts → code → test → revise

02

HOW I USED IT

- Built basic app concept and layout for Snow Leopard Snowboarding
- Generated a basic webpage template and then modified it to match my needs

EXAMPLES:

in the Opus folder, create a P5 animation of a snow leopard snowboarding

✓ Created P5.js animation of snow leopard snowboarding

✓ Created snow_leopard.html

Created `snow_leopard.html` with a more detailed P5.js animation featuring:

- **Parallax scrolling** camera that follows the leopard across a procedurally generated slope
- **Snow leopard** with rosette spots, animated tail, articulated legs, goggles, and a flowing red scarf
- **Terrain** built from sine-wave hills with snow shading
- **Snow spray particles** kicked up on steep sections
- **Scattered pine trees** with snow on their branches (some in front, some behind)
- **Layered mountains** with snow caps and drifting clouds
- **250 snowflakes** with wobble and depth-based opacity
- **HUD** showing a speed readout based on slope angle

Open it in a browser to watch the leopard carve down the mountain!

Claude Opus 4.6 • 3x

can you explaine some of the code in the folder i am in

✓ Reviewed current file in Sonnet folder

✓ Reviewed snow_leopard.html and checked Sonnet files

The Sonnet folder has one file — `snow_leopard.html` — a P5.js animation of a snow leopard snowboarding. Here's a breakdown:

Structure

The file is a self-contained HTML page that loads **P5.js** (a creative coding library) and defines everything in a single `<script>` block using three classes.

Key Classes

`SnowLeopard` (lines 88–280)

- **Movement** (line 97): The leopard moves right at a constant speed. Its Y position follows a sine wave (`sin(this.x * 0.01) * 50`) plus a downward slope (`this.x * 0.25`), creating a smooth curved path.
- **Wobble** (line 103): A counter increments each frame and feeds into `sin()` to create gentle rocking and tail-wagging animations.
- **Drawing**: The leopard is drawn part-by-part — `drawBody()`, `drawHead()`, `drawTail()`, `drawLegs()`, `drawSnowboard()` — each using P5's shape primitives (ellipses, bezier curves, triangles). The `push()/pop()` calls isolate each part's coordinate transforms so they don't affect each other.

Two prompts displayed, the first is me prompting it to create the snow leopard animation, and the next is me asking it to explain the code that it used.

TOOL 1 OVERVIEW CONTINUED

TOOL 2 OVERVIEW: GOOGLE CALENDAR

01

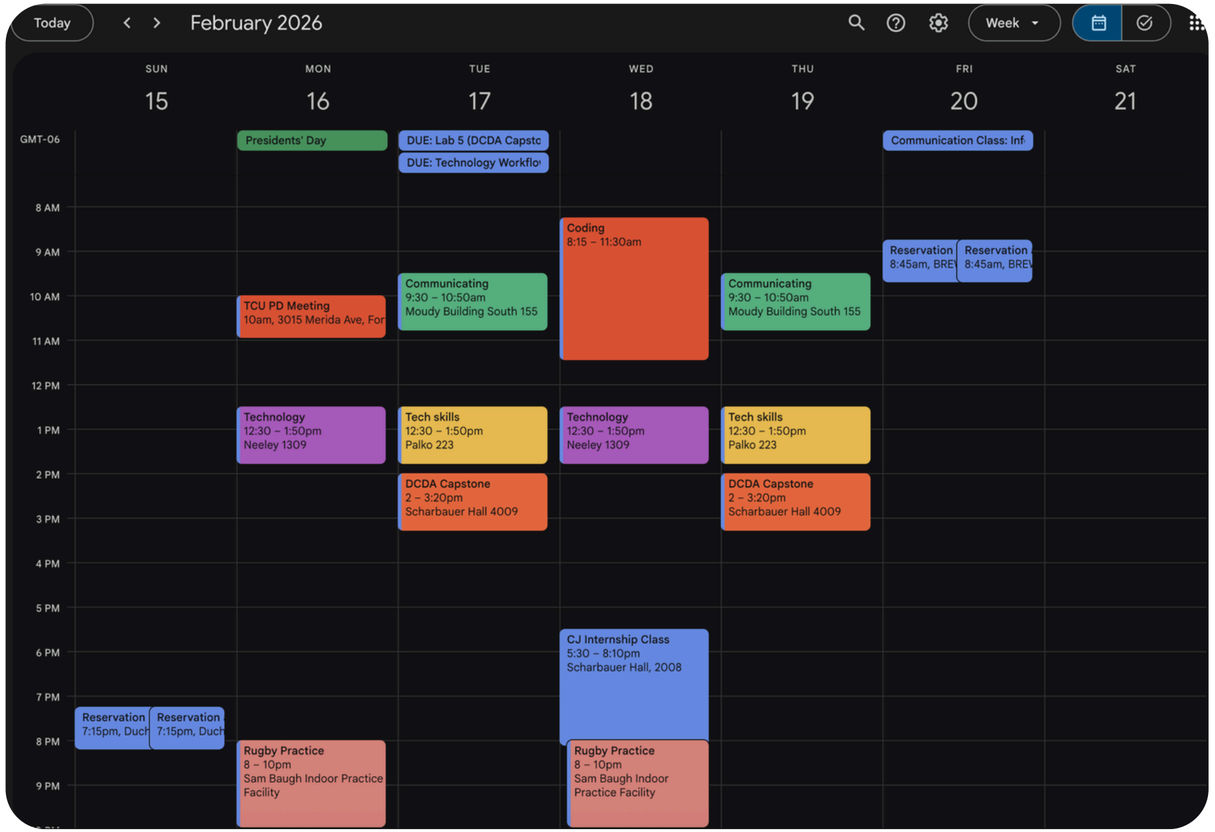
WHAT IT DOES

- Schedules time blocks and sends reminders
- Makes deadlines and work time visible in weekly previews
- Easy to reschedule without losing the plan

02

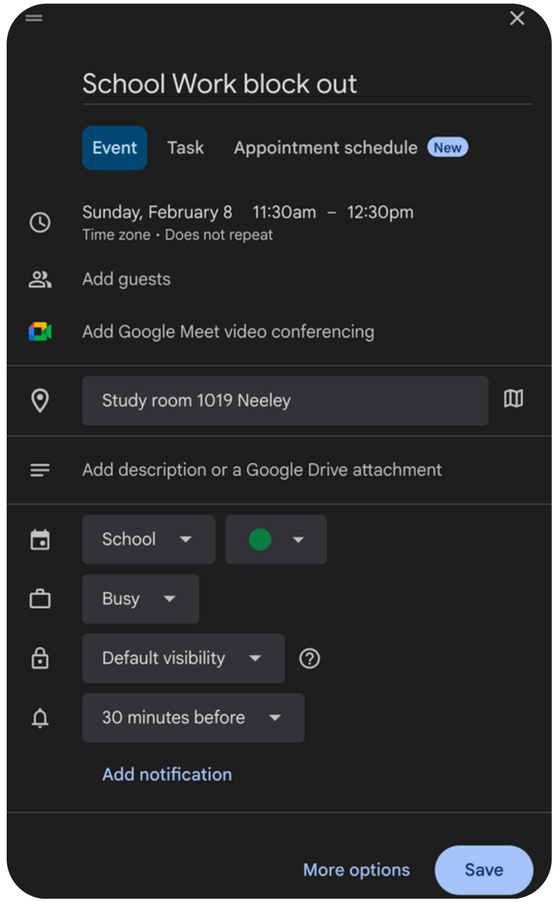
HOW I USED IT

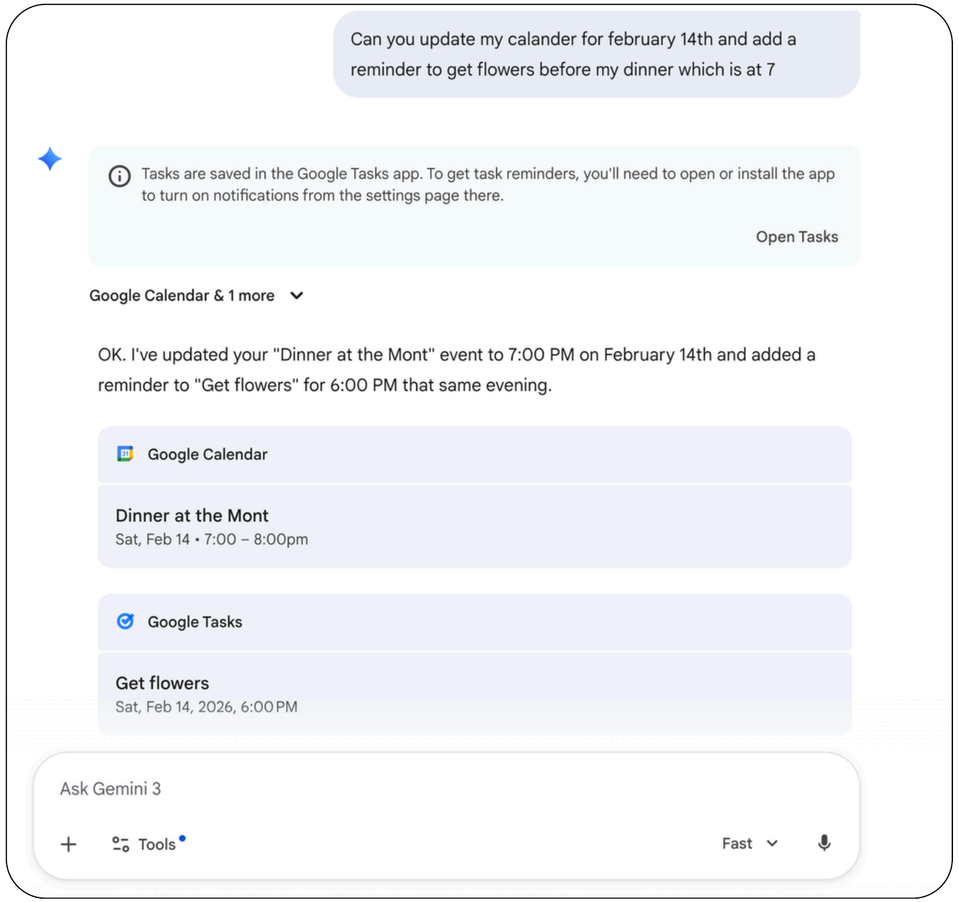
- Scheduled recurring class and work blocks
- Added reminders for class deadlines and check-ins



Screenshot of Google Calendar schedule for week of 2/15/26

EXAMPLES:





TOOL 2 OVERVIEW CONTINUED

The first image shows how you can easily create an event or task within the app, and the second image shows me creating a reminder using Google Gemini which can directly link to your Google calendar

2-WEEK OBSERVATION LOG

Week	Copilot Chat use	Google Calendar use	Wins	Challenges	Change over time
Week 1 (start)	Prompted Copilot to generate a Snow Leopard	Blocked out class schedule and other events	Fast starting momentum	Output needed cleanup	Learned to be more specific
Week 1 (mid)	Asked Copilot for a basic webpage template	Added reminders for check-ins/deadlines	Got a professional-looking layout quickly	Some CSS didn’t match my style	Began editing manually more
Week 1 (end)	Used Copilot to troubleshoot HTML/CSS issues	Weekly review + rescheduled one session	Less time stuck debugging	Needed to verify suggestions	More confident testing changes
Week 2 (start)	Iterated: improved sections, added placeholders, refined	Set shorter but more frequent blocks	More consistent progress	Context limits in chat	Gave better context in prompts
Week 2 (mid)	Refactored and simplified code based on Copilot suggestions	Protected a longer build session	Cleaner structure	Avoided over-relying	Used Copilot as assistant
Week 2 (end)	Used Copilot to add comments + explain code for reflection	Planned next week workflow	Better understanding + clarity	None major	Workflow felt repeatable

EVALUATION: GITHUB COPILOT

01

RELATIVE ADVANTAGE

Saved time by generating starter templates and speeding up iteration compared to searching tutorials and building from scratch.

2

COMPATIBILITY

Highly compatible with my workflow because it lives inside VS Code where I already do all my coding.

3

COMPLEXITY

Moderate. Easy to start, but best results require good prompts and verifying output through testing.

4

TRIALABILITY

High. I could test it on small tasks (template generation, specific UI sections, debugging) before using it for bigger pieces.

5

OBSERVABILITY

Very visible results: working page structure, faster prototypes, fewer stuck moments, and a clearer before/after in my code.

EVALUATION: GOOGLE CALENDAR

01

relative advantage

Time-blocking made work sessions happen consistently instead of relying on motivation.

2

Compatibility

Fits student life and project deadlines, and works across phone/laptop.

3

Complexity

Low. Easy to set recurring events, reminders, and reschedule.

4

Trialability

High. Free and immediate; I tested it by adding only a few coding blocks first.

5

Observability

I could see my progress through completed time blocks and fewer last-minute crunches.

REFLECTION

Over the past two weeks, using GitHub Copilot Chat in VS Code and Google Calendar (with Gemini's calendar integration) changed both how I build projects and how I manage my time. For Copilot, the biggest impact was how quickly I could move from an idea to something real on the screen. When I worked on my "Snow Leopard Snowboarding" concept, I used Copilot in a very specific, repeatable cycle: I prompted it to create a snow leopard animation, reviewed the code it produced, and then used a second prompt to have it explain the code back to me. That pattern made the tool feel less like "copy and paste" and more like a structured assistant. The code generation helped me break through the blank,page problem, and the explanation prompt helped me understand what I was actually implementing, which matters for learning and for being able to defend my work in class.

Over time, I noticed that Copilot worked best when I was clear about constraints and when I treated the output as a draft. Early on, I was tempted to accept large chunks of generated code at once. As I tested and refined, I realized it was more effective to work in smaller steps: generate a basic version, run it, and then adjust. The explanation feature was especially useful because it helped me translate "working code" into understanding. Seeing the animation prompt, the produced code, and then a plain,language explanation made it easier to identify what I wanted to keep, what I wanted to change, and where I needed to verify things myself. It also helped me write cleaner comments and talk through the logic without guessing.

Google Calendar influenced a different part of my workflow: consistency. The week schedule screenshot I included shows how I used Calendar to plan my routine and give work time a real place in my week. The act of creating an event inside the app reinforced that this tool wasn't just a place to "look at my schedule", it was where I actively designed my week. Instead of hoping I would find time later, I could block it in advance and reduce last-minute stress.

The most interesting part of the time-management side was using Gemini to create a calendar event for Valentine's Day. That showed how AI can support productivity outside of coding: by reducing friction for small tasks. Instead of manually entering details, I could use Gemini to generate the event and link it directly to my calendar. That felt like a practical example of AI improving workflow, saving time on administrative steps so I can focus on what matters.

Overall, Copilot improved my workflow by accelerating creation and helping me learn through explanations, while Google Calendar improved my habits by making my time commitments visible and easier to follow. I plan to keep using Copilot for prototyping, debugging, and "explain this" prompts, but I'll continue to verify outputs through testing so I don't rely on it blindly. I also plan to keep using Google Calendar as my central schedule, and I'll keep using Gemini for quick event creation when it saves time. Together, these tools made my workflow faster, more structured, and easier to repeat.